Interactive Resource Finder: Technical Specification and Acceptance Tests

Small static HTML/CSS/JS resource toolkit for fictional public information material

Document ID	PSRO-DEV-005	Revision	0.1
Owner	Demo Content Operations	Status	Illustrative draft

Scope note: The Public Services Resource Office (PSRO) is an invented organization. All assets, personas, metrics, evidence IDs, and review outcomes in this document are synthetic. No federal agency approved or used this procedure.

Overview and constraints

The sample toolkit uses plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript with no build tooling, user accounts, tracking or network requests. It loads a hardcoded sample catalog of 12 synthetic resources and supports a case-insensitive search, category filtering, visible count, clear filters and file metadata. The prototype is not an official agency site or approved distribution service.

Using native labels, select, buttons, anchors and semantic landmarks reduces custom ARIA complexity. The demo avoids a custom combobox; the filter can be operated using standard keyboard navigation.

Functional requirements and traceability

ID	Requirement	Test
REQ-01	Query title, tags and keywords, case-insensitive	AT-01
REQ-02	Filter by category; combine with search	AT-02
REQ-03	Clear resets search/category and focus stays usable	AT-03
REQ-04	Display a text result count and empty-state suggestion	AT-04
REQ-05	Each link references a local example resource with a valid file target	AT-05
REQ-06	Input labels, headings, visible focus and keyboard controls	AT-06

Acceptance scenarios

Case	Setup/action	Expected result
AT-01	Type “appointment” into search field	Related appointment result(s) visible
AT-02	Choose Forms + enter eligibility	Form result(s) only
AT-03	Click Clear filters	Unfiltered catalog restored
AT-04	Enter an impossible word	0 results + clear next action
AT-05	Open resource link	Local sample resource opens

AT-06	Tab through controls and activate by keyboard	Predictable native focus, no mouse requirement

Manual AT-06 verification is still required in the user's target browsers and with assistive technologies. HTML static source can be reviewed for labels and semantic elements, but that is not a substitute for an accessibility conformance test.

Maintainer guide

1. Edit resources.js to add or revise a synthetic asset; retain a unique asset ID.
2. Use the inventory spreadsheet as the canonical content source in a real implementation; this example hardcodes records for offline demonstration only.
3. Do not add links to real government content without clearance and a stable authoritative source.
4. Open index.html in a browser; run AT-01 through AT-06 and record results in the test register.
5. Check browser console and broken links, then run keyboard-only and accessibility assessment procedures with documented tools.
6. Document any change in CHANGELOG.md and review impact on labels and empty-state messaging.

Design decisions and tradeoffs

A native HTML select was chosen over an ARIA combobox because it works with ordinary keyboard input and is easier to maintain. The toy dataset has no authentication and is not intended for processing personal information. A real tool would require content permissions, versioning, telemetry governance, and agency security/privacy reviews.

Reference basis and limitations

Primary reference: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/ . Additional source links and applicability are documented in review/REFERENCE_REGISTER.md.

Compliance note: Section 508 applies to covered federal ICT; WCAG 2.0 A/AA is incorporated by reference in the revised standards. WCAG 2.2 is noted only as complementary guidance. Automated checks do not establish full conformance. DHS Trusted Tester certification is not claimed.

2026 accessibility, content-security and acceptance update

Standards review: November 3, 2026. These additional controls and verification expectations are recommendations or conditional obligations for real federal systems; they are not evidence that the fictional PSRO system is approved, tested or compliant.

Additional accessibility acceptance criteria

Confirm results and filter behavior without mouse input; test logical focus order and focus visibility; ensure search, categories and reset have accessible names; test 200% and 400% zoom, reflow, text spacing, contrast and high-contrast settings as applicable; test status announcement with a screen reader. These checks are planned, not recorded as executed.

Resource metadata and provenance

Each entry in a production resource library should have stable ID, title, category, current version, owner, review date, format, alternate-format route, canonical source, and disposition/retention requirements. This prototype links multiple mock catalog items to a single explanatory placeholder page and does not provide 12 independent production assets.

Security/privacy boundary

The current offline prototype has no authentication, telemetry, submissions or backend. If converted to a live public or internal federal application, obtain relevant platform security, privacy, accessibility and publication approvals before collecting usage data or distributing official materials.

Test status

Automated file, source, and link checks may be run during packaging; browser-level keyboard and assistive-technology testing, DHS Trusted Tester evaluation and real user testing are still outstanding. Avoid asserting completed conformance or official certification.

Primary references for this addendum

- Section 508 Revised Standards: https://www.access-board.gov/ict/
- Electronic Document Testing Baseline: https://ictbaseline.access-board.gov/document-baselines/
- Federal Document Testing: https://www.section508.gov/test/documents/
- DHS Trusted Tester: https://www.section508.gov/test/trusted-tester/
- WCAG 2.2: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/